

GRADE 7 · READING LITERATURE · RL.7.6

Character Perspectives

Analyze how the author develops and contrasts the perspectives of two characters by examining what each character does, says, and thinks.

Lesson Map · Passage · Guided · Partner · Independent Practice · Small Group · Answer Key

What You Will Learn Today

Learning Goals

Understand RL.7.6: Analyze how the author develops and contrasts the perspectives of two ...

Read an original passage closely

Support every answer with text evidence

Work through guided, partner, and independent practice

How the Lesson Runs

Warm-up and passage

Guided practice together

Partner discussion

Independent + small-group work

Exit ticket and answer key

Unpacking the Standard

Perspective is how a character sees and understands events, shaped by their own values, worries, or history. Authors contrast perspectives by showing two characters reacting differently to the same situation. Look at dialogue, actions, and described thoughts to understand each character's view.

Modeled Example

Two characters watch a building get demolished. One says "finally," and one goes quiet. What does this contrast suggest?

It suggests one character is relieved or wanted the change, while the other may feel loss or sentimental attachment — the same event affects them differently based on their perspective.

If a character's internal thought contradicts what they say aloud, what does that reveal?

It reveals a gap between their true feelings and what they are willing to express, often showing complexity or hidden concern.

Two Directors

1. Rosario and Gerald had co-directed the Willow Street community garden for six years, an arrangement that mostly worked because they rarely needed to agree on anything at once.
2. When the city offered a grant to renovate the garden's irrigation system, Rosario read the proposal twice and began making a list of which plots would need to be temporarily closed. Gerald read it once and immediately started drafting an email suggesting they expand the garden's footprint while they had the funding's attention.
3. "We should ask for exactly what fixes the pipes," Rosario said at their next meeting, sliding her plot-closure list across the table. "If we ask for more, we risk delaying approval, and half our plots already flood every spring."
4. Gerald frowned at the list without picking it up. "If we only ask for pipe repair, we'll be back here in three years asking for the same grant, except the expansion opportunity will be gone. Funding windows like this don't stay open."
5. Rosario thought about the eleven families currently waiting for a plot, families she had personally told "next season, we hope," more than once. Gerald thought about the eight additional plots an expansion could create, and the families he could stop turning away permanently.

Two Directors, continued

7. Gerald looked at her plot-closure list again, this time actually reading it. "Your list assumes we get denied if we ask for too much." "Your email assumes we get denied if we ask for too little," Rosario said.

8. Neither of them was fully right. In the end, they submitted a proposal requesting the pipe repair with a modest, clearly justified expansion of two plots — Rosario's caution shaping the ask, Gerald's ambition shaping its size.

Warm-up · Before You Read

1. What explicit action does Rosario take first when she receives the grant proposal?

2. What explicit action does Gerald take first when he receives the same proposal?

Guided Practice

3. What does Rosario's immediate focus on plot closures suggest about her perspective?

4. What does Gerald's immediate focus on expansion suggest about his perspective?

Guided Practice

5. What reason does Rosario give in paragraph 3 for asking only for pipe repair?

6. What reason does Gerald give in paragraph 4 for wanting to expand now?

Partner Discussion

7. Both characters are worried about the same families. What is different about how each character thinks about those families? Cite paragraph 5.

8. What does Rosario's statement in paragraph 6 ("We're just trying to help them on different timelines") reveal about her understanding of the conflict?

Partner Discussion

9. How does paragraph 7 show each character finally considering the other's viewpoint?

Independent Practice

10. What is Rosario's underlying assumption, according to Gerald's comment in paragraph 7?

11. What is Gerald's underlying assumption, according to Rosario's comment in paragraph 7?

Independent Practice

12. How does the final proposal in paragraph 8 reflect both characters' perspectives?

13. Contrast Rosario's and Gerald's attitudes toward risk, using specific evidence from the story.

Independent Practice

14. Why might the author have chosen not to make either character clearly "right" by the end of the story?

15. How does the six-year co-directorship mentioned in paragraph 1 help explain their contrasting perspectives?

Small-Group Work

16. Find one line of dialogue from each character that best captures their perspective, and explain your choices.

17. How does the author use the described internal thoughts in paragraph 5, rather than dialogue, to develop each character's perspective?

Small-Group Work

18. Does the story suggest one character's perspective is more important to the garden's long-term success? Support your answer with evidence.

19. How does the author signal, through word choice, that Rosario values caution and Gerald values opportunity, even before either character speaks?

Exit Ticket

20. Explain, using two pieces of evidence, how the author contrasts Rosario's and Gerald's perspectives throughout the story.

Answer Key (1 of 4)

1. She reads it twice and begins making a list of which plots would need to be temporarily closed.
2. He reads it once and starts drafting an email suggesting they expand the garden's footprint.
3. She is cautious and focused on practical, immediate risks (like flooding and disruption) rather than opportunity.
4. He is opportunity-focused and future-oriented, more willing to take a risk to achieve a larger long-term gain.
5. Asking for more risks delaying approval, and half the plots already flood every spring.

Answer Key (2 of 4)

6. If they only ask for pipe repair, they will need to seek the same grant again in three years, but the expansion opportunity and funding window may not still be available.
7. Rosario thinks about the eleven families currently waiting and her promises to them ("next season, we hope"); Gerald thinks about the eight additional plots an expansion could create for families he is turning away, focusing on a future solution rather than the current wait.
8. She recognizes that she and Gerald share the same goal but differ in urgency and approach, showing a moment of perspective-taking rather than blame.
9. Gerald actually reads Rosario's list for the first time, and both point out the underlying assumption in the other's plan (that asking for too much or too little risks denial), showing mutual recognition.
10. That asking for too much in the grant proposal risks getting the whole request denied.

Answer Key (3 of 4)

11. That asking for too little means missing the chance to solve the problem for good, since the funding opportunity may not return.

12. It includes the pipe repair Rosario prioritized for safety and urgency, plus a modest expansion reflecting Gerald's long-term ambition, blending both viewpoints rather than choosing one.

13. Rosario is risk-averse about approval delays and prioritizes a safer, smaller ask (paragraph 3); Gerald is risk-tolerant about the process but risk-averse about losing the funding opportunity itself (paragraph 4) — both avoid risk, just different kinds.

14. It shows that differing, valid perspectives can both contribute something useful, and that resolving conflict does not always require one person to be wrong.

15. It shows they have different but established styles that have coexisted for years, suggesting their perspectives are long-standing traits, not new reactions to this one situation.

Answer Key (4 of 4)

16. Rosario: "If we ask for more, we risk delaying approval" shows her caution; Gerald: "Funding windows like this don't stay open" shows his focus on long-term opportunity.

17. By describing what each character privately thinks about the same eleven or eight families, the author shows both characters' deeper motivations are compassionate, even though their outward approaches conflict — something dialogue alone might not reveal as clearly.

18. Answers vary; support should cite specific evidence — for example, the final compromise in paragraph 8 uses both perspectives, suggesting neither alone was sufficient, which could support an answer that both are equally necessary.

19. Paragraph 2 describes Rosario making "a list of which plots would need to be temporarily closed" (careful, procedural) while Gerald "immediately" drafts an email about expansion (quick, opportunity-seeking), establishing their perspectives through action before any dialogue.

20. Answers vary; require two specific, correctly cited examples (from dialogue, action, or described thought) that clearly show differing viewpoints between the two characters.

Exit Ticket

Answer on a sticky note

Answer the exit-ticket question from today's lesson.

Cite at least one piece of evidence from the passage.

Remember

Name your claim or answer

Quote or cite the evidence

Explain how it supports your answer